



Gesellschaft für experimentelle Wirtschaftsforschung e.V.
German Association for Experimental Economic Research e.V.

Institutional Review Board Certificate

No. 19HBJNwQ

<https://gfew.de/ethik/19HBJNwQ>

Date: 11/13/2025

Certificate Expires: 11/13/2027

Status: Approved

Review Level: Expedite

Details of Experiment:

Titel

Reliance on Normative vs Preferential Algorithms

Authors

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Short description of the experimental study

In a first part, participants make 12 binary choices between lotteries. In the second part, they are assigned to one of two treatments. In the PREF treatment, they can delegate a choice between 8 lotteries to an algorithm that chooses how it predicts the participants would choose themselves (given indefinite time), or make the lottery choice themselves. In the EV treatment, they have the option of delegating the same choices (as in the PREF treatment) to an expected-value-maximizing algorithm. The second part has 8 rounds and end with a hypothetical choice about en-block delegation in 10 additional (fictitious) rounds.

The German Association for Experimental Economic Research (Gesellschaft für experimentelle Wirtschaftsforschung - Gfew) provides this certificate of approval in an expedited review process according the rules and procedures approved by the members of the association on September 25, 2024. The criteria for approving an ethics certificate can be retrieved here: <https://gfew.de/criteria>

The approval is based on the agreement of the proposers to abide by the legal requirements of the European Union and by the policies and procedures of the Gfew. Furthermore, the approval is only valid, if (i) the proposers have provided all necessary information completely and truthfully, (ii) no part of the planned experimental project has been conducted before the approval was granted, and (iii) the experimental project is conducted as described.

This approval does not supercede or replace decisions by other statutory bodies. Furthermore, it is not a substitute for certifications or approvals that are required by law, by the statutes of the involved research institutes, or by the codes of

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conduct that are applicable to the participating researchers, including those from other fields of research.

The expiration date of the approval is noted above. To continue the proposed experimental study beyond that date, a new approval must be requested, even if the experimental protocol remains unchanged.

Please also note that prior to implementing any changes or amendments in the protocol of the proposed experimental study, a new approval must be requested, even if the new experimental study including the changes or amendments to the protocol is expected to be governed by the Gfew's rules for the expedited review process.

A copy of this letter should be kept in the records together with all documents associated with this experimental study.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'J. Lambsdorff'.

Prof. Dr. Johann Graf Lambsdorff
President of the Gfew

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Björn Frank'.

Prof. Dr. Björn Frank
Vice-President of the Gfew